



Data Governance Self-Audit

Thirteen checks. Fifteen minutes. The same questions we ask in a paid audit.

Work through the thirteen statements below. Check the box only if it is true today, not after the next cleanup. Be honest; nobody sees this but you. Your count of unchecked boxes tells you where you stand.

A. Definitions and ownership

The part most organizations skip.

- ☐ **Every key metric has one written definition that Finance, Operations, and IT have agreed to.**
If Finance and Operations would give two different numbers for loss and waste, check no.
- ☐ **Every metric has a named owner who reviews it on a set cadence.**
A dashboard without an owner is a report nobody acts on.
- ☐ **You can trace each metric to a single source of truth.**
One system, one table, one calculation. Not a chain of spreadsheets.

B. Access and security

Where audits find the scary stuff.

- ☐ **No departed employees hold access to your BI environment.**
Check the admin lists first. We have found former employees holding admin rights on the highest-risk workspaces.
- ☐ **Access is granted through security groups, not one person at a time.**
Individual grants rot. Groups managed in Active Directory (or your identity platform) persist.
- ☐ **Every workspace has one named owner and only the admins it needs.**
Four admins and no owner means nobody is accountable.
- ☐ **Roles follow least privilege.**
Admins manage access. Members publish. Contributors build. Everyone else views, through a group.

C. Data classification

Classify once, route everywhere.

- ☐ **Your data is classified into tiers.**
For example: Internal, Confidential, Restricted (PII), and Restricted-Derived (modeled attributes that imply something sensitive).
- ☐ **Customer or employee PII never shares a workspace with general content.**
Customer records sitting beside marketing dashboards means one over-shared link exposes both.
- ☐ **Higher tiers route to their own workspaces with tighter membership.**
If everything lives in one workspace, your access model is one mistake wide.

D. Model and report hygiene

Where the hidden labor hides.

- ☐ **Master data lives in one shared, certified model.**
We once counted 24 independent, disagreeing copies of the same item master, one per report.
- ☐ **Refresh schedules are monitored and failures alert someone.**
A dashboard quietly showing last month's data is worse than no dashboard.
- ☐ **Nobody maintains a spreadsheet whose job is reconciling two reports.**
Shadow reconciliation systems are the surest symptom of missing governance.

Scoring: count your unchecked boxes

0-2 unchecked. Solid foundation. Re-run this quarterly to keep it that way.

3-5 unchecked. Gaps are forming. Pick the two that touch money or PII and fix those first.

6+ unchecked. Your reporting estate is running on trust, not governance. An audit will find things you cannot see from the inside; ours also covers refresh health, capacity headroom, and model duplication.

Want a second set of eyes?

Book a 30-minute discovery call and walk through your results with us: calendly.com/kettleriverbi/30min